

INDIAN FOODS ONLY

3 MEAL PLANS

BUDGET GUIDE

RESTAURANT TIPS

THE INDIAN BODYBUILDER'S COMPLETE NUTRITION BIBLE

High-Protein Indian Foods · Meal Plans for Every Goal · Budget Guide · Restaurant Strategies

Build muscle and lose fat with traditional Indian cuisine — no imported foods needed

ELITE FITNESS GUIDE SERIES

Research-Based · Professional Edition · 2024

■ TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Top 30 High-Protein Indian Foods Ranked
2. Indian Foods Macronutrient Reference Table
3. Bulking Meal Plan — 3000–3500 kcal/day
4. Cutting Meal Plan — 1600–2000 kcal/day
5. Maintenance & Recomp Plan — 2200–2600 kcal/day
6. Pre-Workout Meals (Indian)
7. Post-Workout Meals (Indian)
8. Budget-Friendly Protein Sources
9. Eating Out — Indian Restaurant Strategy
10. Festival & Social Event Survival Guide
11. Supplement Stack for Indian Athletes
12. Common Myths About Indian Food & Fitness

■ 1. TOP 30 HIGH-PROTEIN INDIAN FOODS

Rank	Food	Serving	Protein	Calories	Cost/Serving
1	Chicken Breast (skinless)	100g	31g	165 kcal	■15–20
2	Paneer (low-fat homemade)	100g	18–22g	260 kcal	■20–25
3	Eggs (whole)	1 large	6g	70 kcal	■6–8
4	Moong Dal (cooked)	1 cup (200g)	14g	212 kcal	■8–12
5	Chana Dal (cooked)	1 cup	15g	270 kcal	■8–12
6	Rajma / Kidney Beans	1 cup (cooked)	15g	225 kcal	■12–15
7	Soya Chunks (dried)	50g dry	26g	170 kcal	■10–15
8	Greek Yogurt / Hung Curd	200g	12–16g	130 kcal	■25–35
9	Tuna (canned in water)	100g	25g	116 kcal	■40–60
10	Rohu / Katla Fish	100g cooked	22g	97 kcal	■25–40
11	Sattu (roasted chickpea flour)	50g	12g	180 kcal	■10–15
12	Quinoa (cooked)	1 cup (185g)	8g	222 kcal	■50–70
13	Cow's Milk (full fat)	300ml	9g	186 kcal	■15–20
14	Whey Protein (local brand)	1 scoop (30g)	22–25g	120 kcal	■50–80
15	Chickpeas / Kabuli Chana	1 cup cooked	15g	269 kcal	■12–18

■ 2. MACRONUTRIENT REFERENCE TABLE

Food (100g unless noted)	Calories	Protein	Carbs	Fats	Fiber
Cooked White Rice	130	2.7g	28g	0.3g	0.4g
Whole Wheat Roti (1 medium)	71	2.5g	13g	1g	1.2g
Oats (dry)	389	17g	66g	7g	10g
Sweet Potato (cooked)	86	1.6g	20g	0.1g	3g
Banana (medium)	89	1.1g	23g	0.3g	2.6g
Broccoli (100g)	34	2.8g	7g	0.4g	2.6g
Spinach (raw 100g)	23	2.9g	3.6g	0.4g	2.2g
Almonds (30g)	174	6g	6g	15g	3g
Peanut Butter (1 tbsp)	94	4g	3g	8g	1g
Ghee (1 tsp/5g)	45	0	0	5g	0
Coconut Oil (1 tbsp)	120	0	0	14g	0

■ 3. BULKING MEAL PLAN — 3000–3500 KCAL/DAY

Target macros: 180–220g protein · 350–400g carbs · 80–100g fats

Meal	Time	Menu	~Protein	~Kcal
Breakfast	7:00 AM	2 whole eggs scrambled with 50g paneer + 2 multigrain rotis + 1 banana + masala chai (full fat milk)	35g	620
Mid-Morning	10:00 AM	50g soya chunks (cooked in minimal oil) + 1 cup brown rice + 100g curd + 1 fruit	25g	500
Pre-Workout	12:30 PM	3 rotis + 150g chicken/paneer curry + salad	35g	580
Post-Workout	3:30 PM	1 scoop whey protein + 1 banana + 10 almonds	30g	320
Dinner	7:00 PM	200g dal (any) + 3 rotis + 100g paneer sabzi + vegetables	35g	680
Before Bed	9:30 PM	200g full-fat curd + 10g chia seeds + handful of mixed nuts	15g	300
TOTAL			175–200g	3000–3500

■ 4. CUTTING MEAL PLAN — 1600–2000 KCAL/DAY

Target macros: 160–180g protein · 120–150g carbs · 40–55g fats

Meal	Time	Menu	~Protein	~Kcal
Breakfast	7:00 AM	3 egg whites + 1 whole egg scrambled + ½ cup oats with water + green tea	30g	320
Mid-Morning	10:30 AM	1 cup moong dal soup + 100g cucumber + 1 cup green tea	12g	180
Lunch	1:00 PM	50g grilled chicken/paneer + 1 roti + large salad (cucumber, tomato, onion, lemon)	40g	380
Snack	4:30 PM	200g low-fat curd + 1 tsp jeera + 10 almonds	14g	200
Dinner	7:30 PM	200g dal (thin) + 2 rotis + steamed mixed vegetables + salad	28g	450
TOTAL			124–150g	1600–1800

■ 5. RECOMP PLAN — 2200–2600 KCAL/DAY

Recomposition (building muscle and losing fat simultaneously) requires eating near TDEE with high protein and strategic carb timing:

Meal	Menu	Notes
Breakfast	4 whole eggs + 2 rotis + 100g vegetables + chai	High protein start
Post-Workout	50g whey/sattu + 1 banana + 5 almonds	Fast carbs + protein within 45 min
Lunch	175g dal/legumes + 2 rotis + 100g paneer + salad	Largest meal; most carbs
Snack	150g Greek yogurt + mixed seeds	Protein + healthy fats
Dinner	200g fish or chicken + 1 roti + vegetables + salad	Protein dominant; reduce carbs at night

■ 6–7. PRE & POST WORKOUT MEALS

Pre-Workout Meals (2–3 hours before training):

Option	Protein	Carbs	Preparation Time
3 rotis + dal + curd	20–25g	45–55g	Cook ahead; reliable classic
Oats porridge + boiled egg (2) + banana	22g	60g	15 min prep; easy
Sattu drink (50g sattu + lemon + salt + water) + 3 almonds	14g	25g	5 min; great for busy mornings
Brown rice (1 cup) + paneer (100g) + vegetables	25g	45g	Meal-prep friendly

Post-Workout Meals (within 45–60 min of training):

Option	Protein	Carbs	Why
Whey protein + banana + 10 almonds	28g	30g	Fastest; optimal amino acid profile for muscle protein synthesis
Poha (cooked) + 2 boiled eggs	18g	40g	Complete meal; traditional Indian; fast carbs from poha
Sattu lassi (50g sattu + curd + banana)	18g	45g	Budget-friendly whole food option; high in fiber and minerals
Paneer bhurji + 2 rotis	30g	28g	High protein; great if training before lunch or dinner

■ 8–12. BUDGET · RESTAURANTS · FESTIVALS · SUPPLEMENTS · MYTHS

Budget-Friendly Protein Sources (ranked by protein-per-rupee):

Rank	Food	Protein per ■10	Notes
1	Eggs	~8g	Best value in India; complete protein
2	Moong/Chana Dal	~12g	Dried pulse; incredible value; high fibre
3	Soya Chunks	~18g (dry weight basis)	Best plant protein per rupee in India
4	Sattu	~14g	Underused superfood; complete amino profile
5	Paneer (homemade)	~9g	Make from full-fat milk — 50% cheaper than store-bought
6	Tuna (canned)	~6g	Great value if on sale; complete protein

Restaurant Ordering Strategy:

- Ask for **less oil/ghee** in sabzi — most restaurants use 3–5× the home cooking amount
- Choose **grilled/tandoor options** over fried: tandoori chicken vs butter chicken saves 200+ kcal
- **Dal over paneer** dishes when protein-focused: dal provides better protein-to-calorie ratio
- Skip biryani; choose **brown rice or 2 rotis** instead; avoid paratha (loaded with ghee)
- Order **raita** (curd-based) instead of heavy gravies; ask for salad before meal
- At weddings/buffets: **protein-first strategy** — fill plate with dal, paneer, chicken before touching rice/bread

Festival Survival Guide:

- **Diwali/Eid/Christmas:** Eat normally all day; at event, protein-first then 1–2 portions of festive food. Guilt-free enjoyment in moderation
- **Holi/Navratri:** Stock up on fruit, nuts, and dairy alternatives if fasting is cultural practice
- **Ramadan fasting:** Sehri (pre-dawn) should be high-protein + complex carbs; Iftar should start with dates + water then protein-rich meal before carbs

Common Myths Debunked:

Myth	Reality
Dal makes you fat	Dal is one of the best weight-loss foods — high protein, high fibre, low fat. Problem is the ghee tadka, not the dal itself
Ghee is unhealthy	Pure cow ghee contains CLA, butyric acid, and fat-soluble vitamins. 1–2 tsp/day is beneficial, not harmful
Rice/roti cause weight gain	No single food causes weight gain — total caloric surplus does. White rice has lower fibre than brown but is not 'bad'
Indian food can't build muscle	India produces world-class athletes on dal-rice-sabzi diets. Total protein intake matters, not the source
Need expensive protein supplements	Soya chunks, eggs, and dal provide complete protein at a fraction of whey protein cost